

Day 5 — Class Summary

MODULE 01 • HTML BEST PRACTICES, CSS, LAYOUTS & THE FOUNDER MINDSET

A record of everything we covered in today's session — from HTML structure and CSS layouts all the way to how to think about building real products.

1 HTML structure & best practices

We went deep on how to structure HTML properly, the way it's done in industry:

- How to structure an HTML document cleanly and consistently.
- Why **semantic tags** matter — and how they improve **accessibility**, **maintainability**, and **SEO**.
- Several industry best practices that separate professional markup from beginner markup.

2 CSS fundamentals

From there we moved into CSS and the core styling concepts:

- **Typography** — how type choices shape how a page feels and reads.
- **Colours & branding** — using colour with intent, not decoration.
- The other core styling fundamentals that make a page look considered.

3 Advanced layouts: Flexbox & CSS Grid

We then explored the two modern layout tools and, importantly, when to use each:

- **Flexbox vs Grid** — the difference, and the use cases each one is built for.
- When to choose one over the other depending on the problem in front of you.
- Which approach to reach for **first**, based on the kind of layout you're building.
- Best practices for creating modern, **responsive** layouts the way professional front-end developers do.

4 Live review exercise

We opened the Amrapali University website together and used it as a real-world case study — identifying usability and design points, and discussing how we would approach the problem if we were the ones responsible for redesigning it. Reviewing a site everyone knows is the fastest way to apply what we'd just learned and to build a critical eye for structure and design.

5 From developer to founder

Beyond the technical work, I tried to shift how the students think about what they're building. Great products come from solving real problems that affect a large number of people, through technology. The goal isn't to stop at a résumé or a PDF export — it's to build real products, solve meaningful problems, and create work that has genuine impact.

Don't just write code that works. Build things that solve real problems for real people. That's the difference between a developer and a founder.